

Employee Expense Reimbursement Policy

Travel, business expenses, and per-diem guidance for all Zaya employees

Policy Owner	Finance & People Operations
Policy Number	ZP-FIN-014
Effective Date	January 1, 2026
Last Reviewed	March 12, 2026
Applies To	All Zaya full-time and part-time employees, including contractors with PO approval

1. Purpose

Zaya is committed to enabling our teams to do their best work, whether that means traveling to customer sites, attending conferences, or hosting clients. This Expense Reimbursement Policy establishes the framework by which employees may incur, document, and recover legitimate business expenses on behalf of the company. The policy is designed to be generous in spirit but rigorous in practice: spend Zaya money as if it were your own, but never hesitate to invest in outcomes that matter to our customers and our mission.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all reimbursable expenses incurred by Zaya employees worldwide. Vendor invoices, capital purchases, and recurring SaaS subscriptions are governed by the Procurement Policy (ZP-FIN-007) and are explicitly out of scope here.

3. General Principles

- **Business purpose.** Every expense must have a clear connection to Zaya's business and be documented in the expense report narrative.
- **Reasonableness.** Spend should be proportional to the outcome. A \$14 airport sandwich is fine; a \$400 steakhouse dinner alone is not.
- **Documentation.** Itemized receipts are required for all expenses of \$25 USD or more. Credit-card slips alone are not acceptable.
- **Timeliness.** Submit expense reports within 30 days of the transaction date. Submissions older than 90 days require VP approval and may be denied.
- **No personal benefit.** Expenses that primarily benefit the employee personally (gym memberships, commuting, personal entertainment) are not reimbursable.

4. Travel — Air, Rail, and Ground

Zaya books all air and rail travel through the Navan corporate booking tool. Employees should book the lowest logical fare in economy class for any flight under six hours. Flights over six hours, or red-eye itineraries with same-day customer engagements, may be booked in premium economy with manager approval. Business class is reserved for international flights longer than eight hours or for employees with a documented medical accommodation.

Ground transportation including ride-share, taxi, and rental cars is reimbursable when used for business purposes. Employees should select mid-size or smaller rental vehicles unless three or more Zaya travelers are sharing the vehicle, in which case a larger class is acceptable. Personal vehicle mileage is reimbursed at the current IRS standard rate (currently \$0.67 per mile in the United States).

5. Lodging

Hotel accommodations should be booked through Navan whenever possible. Zaya maintains negotiated rates with Marriott, Hilton, and IHG portfolios. Nightly room rate caps (excluding taxes and resort fees) are listed in the table below. Where the rate cap is exceeded due to a sold-out market or company-mandated event hotel, employees should attach a screenshot of comparable rates and proceed.

City Tier	Examples	Nightly Cap (USD)
Tier 1 — Premium	New York, San Francisco, London, Tokyo	\$350
Tier 2 — Major Metro	Chicago, Boston, Seattle, Austin, Berlin	\$275
Tier 3 — Standard	Most US/EU mid-size cities	\$215
Tier 4 — Other	All remaining locations	\$165

6. Meals and Per-Diems

When traveling on Zaya business, employees may either submit itemized meal receipts up to the daily caps below, or elect the flat per-diem option. Per-diem elections must be declared at the start of the trip and apply to the full trip duration.

- **Breakfast:** up to \$20 USD (per-diem equivalent: \$18)
- **Lunch:** up to \$25 USD (per-diem equivalent: \$22)
- **Dinner:** up to \$60 USD (per-diem equivalent: \$55)
- **Client entertainment:** no fixed cap; requires Director-level approval and a list of attendees.
- **Alcohol:** reimbursable only with meals and only when entertaining clients or peers; never reimbursable for solo meals.

7. Office Equipment and Home Office Stipend

All Zaya employees receive a one-time home office setup stipend of \$1,500 USD upon hire, which may be applied to ergonomic seating, monitors, lighting, and acoustic treatment. In

addition, every employee receives a \$90 monthly internet and connectivity stipend that is added to payroll and does not require receipts. Replacement of damaged equipment is handled by IT (ZP-IT-003), not through this policy.

8. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Traffic and parking violations, including airport vehicle impound fees.
- In-room movies, mini-bar items (except non-alcoholic beverages), and spa charges.
- Personal grooming services such as haircuts, manicures, or dry cleaning under three nights of travel.
- Travel insurance purchased independently — Zaya carries a corporate travel insurance policy that covers all business travel automatically.
- Gifts to government officials of any kind — see the Code of Conduct policy for anti-bribery requirements.

9. Submission and Reimbursement Timeline

All expense reports are submitted in Expensify. Employees should categorize each line item, attach the itemized receipt, and provide a one-line business purpose. Reports are routed automatically to the employee's direct manager, and from there to Finance. Approved reports are paid via direct deposit on the next Friday following final approval — typically within 7 to 10 business days end to end.

10. Policy Violations

Falsifying receipts, submitting personal expenses as business, or repeatedly violating spending caps without justification will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination. Zaya's internal audit team performs random sampling on 5% of all expense reports each quarter. Employees with questions about the policy or specific scenarios should reach out to **finance@zaya.com** or their HR Business Partner.

This policy supersedes ZP-FIN-014 v3.2 (June 2024). Questions and policy interpretation requests should be directed to the Finance Policy Team at finance-policy@zaya.com.